

TITANIC SKULL

TITANOCERATOPS

Probably the biggest of all Late Cretaceous ceratopsians, the gigantic *Titanoceratops* is a contender for the title of the largest skull of any land-living vertebrate animal. Reconstructions tell us that its skull alone was about 8½ ft (2.65 m) in length—roughly the height of an ostrich, the tallest bird alive today! Fossils of *Titanoceratops* were first discovered in 1941, but were left untouched in a museum's storage for more than 50 years, wrapped in a protective covering of plaster. When these fossils were finally studied, the creature was mistakenly identified as *Pentaceratops*, a different ceratopsian often found in the same region as *Titanoceratops*. However, a reexamination of these fossils in 2011 revealed several features unique to this animal, including slender brow horns and tongue-shaped spikes on its frill. Following this discovery, the animal was recognized as a new kind of horned dinosaur.

**LARGEST
SKULL:
LAND ANIMAL**

Broad hip bones served as attachment points for large thigh muscles.

A short tail helped the creature to balance when walking.

Giant bones

Many of *Titanoceratops*'s large bones have been found as fossils, including parts of its arm and the shoulder girdle (a set of bones connected to its forelimbs). The creature's giant skull housed an enormous frill and two curved, forward-facing horns, which were probably used for display but may have also helped scare off deadly predators.

Powerful limbs helped support *Titanoceratops*'s weight.

